

Hackathon Challenge: Take a Local Shop Online 🛒

1. Challenge Overview

You are a team of **3 members** participating in a mini hackathon.

Your challenge is to help a traditional offline shop establish its **online presence** by designing and developing a modern, attractive, and functional website.

Shop Scenario

You have been approached by a fictional local shop called **“UrbanNest Lifestyle Store”**.

UrbanNest is a small offline lifestyle shop that sells products such as:

- Home décor
- Gift items
- Stationery
- Lifestyle accessories
- Small household products

The shop currently operates only through its physical store and wants to **go online** to reach more customers.

Your team has to build a professional website that represents the shop digitally and provides customers with an easy way to interact with the business.

2. Team Requirement

- Each team must consist of **3 members**.
 - All three members should contribute to the project.
 - The team should divide responsibilities such as:
 - UI/UX and landing page
 - Website development
 - AI/chatbot and N8N.io integration
 - Testing and deployment
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3. Main Objective

Build a **complete, responsive, modern business website** for UrbanNest Lifestyle Store.

The website should look like a real commercial website rather than a basic college project.

The website must include:

1. A professional landing page

2. Product/shop information
 3. Customer query form
 4. Integration of the existing **N8N.io query form**
 5. Integration of the existing **N8N.io chatbot**
 6. Responsive design
 7. Deployment on **Render**
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4. Landing Page Requirements

The landing page should immediately communicate what the business offers.

It should contain appropriate sections such as:

Hero Section

Include:

- Shop name
- Short tagline
- Brief description
- Attractive visual
- Call-to-action button

Example:

| **UrbanNest Lifestyle Store** “Little Things. Beautiful Living.”

CTA examples:

- Explore Products
- Ask Us a Question
- Contact Us

About the Shop

Explain:

- What the shop sells
- Why customers should choose it
- What makes the shop different

Featured Products

Display several sample products with:

- Product image
- Product name
- Short description
- Price

The products can be fictional.

Why Choose Us?

Include 3–4 selling points such as:

- Quality Products
- Affordable Prices
- Personalized Service
- Fast Customer Support

Customer Interaction

Provide an obvious way for customers to:

- Submit a query
 - Chat with the shop's AI chatbot
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5. N8N.io Query Form Integration

A **query form has already been created using N8N.io**.

Students **do not need to recreate the query-form backend from scratch**.

They must integrate the existing N8N.io query form into their website.

The form should allow customers to submit information such as:

- Name
- Email
- Query/Message
- Optional phone number
- Category/type of query

The submitted query should be handled by the existing N8N.io setup.

Important

Students should demonstrate that the website is actually connected to the existing N8N.io query form and not simply displaying a dummy HTML form.

6. N8N.io Chatbot Integration

The website must also include the **existing chatbot created using N8N.io**.

The chatbot should be accessible from the website, preferably through:

- A floating chatbot button
- Chat widget
- Dedicated chatbot section

The chatbot should help customers with common questions such as:

- What products do you sell?
- What are your store timings?
- Where is the shop located?
- Do you provide delivery?
- How can I contact you?
- How can I submit a query?

Students should integrate the existing N8N.io chatbot rather than building a completely new chatbot from scratch.

7. UI/UX Requirements

The website should have a **professional and visually appealing design**.

Students will be evaluated on:

- Visual hierarchy
- Typography
- Spacing
- Navigation
- Color combination
- Consistency
- Responsiveness
- Ease of use
- Overall user experience

The website should work properly on:

- Desktop
- Tablet
- Mobile

Avoid making the website look like a basic template or plain HTML assignment.

8. Technical Requirements

The team can choose an appropriate technology stack.

For example:

- HTML/CSS/JavaScript
- React
- Next.js
- Flask
- Node.js
- Any other suitable web technology

The project must successfully integrate:

Website → N8N.io Query Form

and

Website → N8N.io Chatbot

9. Deployment Requirement

The final website **must be deployed on Render**.

Students must submit:

- Live Render URL
- Source code/repository URL
- Project documentation

The submitted Render URL should be publicly accessible and functional.

10. Hackathon Deliverables

Each team must submit:

1. Live Website

A working website deployed on Render.

2. Source Code

GitHub/GitLab repository containing the complete project.

3. N8N.io Integration

Working integration of:

- Existing N8N.io query form
- Existing N8N.io chatbot

4. Short Documentation

The documentation should explain:

- Problem being solved
- Proposed solution
- Technology stack
- Team member contributions
- N8N.io integration
- Deployment process
- Future improvements

5. Final Demonstration

Each team will give a short demonstration showing:

1. Landing page
 2. Navigation
 3. Product section
 4. Query form
 5. Successful query submission
 6. Chatbot
 7. Chatbot interaction
 8. Mobile responsiveness
 9. Live Render deployment
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11. Important Constraints

- Team size: **3 members**
 - Use the provided/existing **N8N.io query form**
 - Use the provided/existing **N8N.io chatbot**
 - Do not replace the N8N.io integrations with dummy components.
 - Website must be responsive.
 - Website must be deployed on Render.
 - The website should contain meaningful business content.
 - All major functionality must work in the final demonstration.
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12. Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	Weightage
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UI/UX & Landing Page Design	20%
Website Functionality	20%
N8N.io Query Form Integration	15%
N8N.io Chatbot Integration	15%
Creativity & Innovation	10%
Responsiveness	10%
Deployment & Documentation	10%
Total	100%

13. Bonus Points

Teams can earn bonus consideration for features such as:

- Product search
 - Product filtering
 - Shopping cart UI
 - Customer testimonials
 - Google Maps/store location
 - Dark/light mode
 - Product categories
 - Offers and discounts section
 - WhatsApp/contact integration
 - AI-powered product recommendations
 - Smooth animations
 - Excellent mobile experience
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14. Expected Final Experience

Imagine a customer discovers **UrbanNest Lifestyle Store** through Google.

They should be able to:

Visit Website → Understand the Shop → Explore Products → Ask the Chatbot → Submit a Query → Contact the Shop

The final website should feel like a **real business website that could actually be given to a local shop owner**, not simply a hackathon prototype.

Final Goal

Build a beautiful, functional and deployed digital presence for a traditional local business using web development + N8N.io integrations + AI chatbot technology.

Build it. Integrate it. Deploy it. Make the shop go online. 🚀